

ing a sport helps me release pressure. It's a way to de-stress."

Smytten promotes sports culture and organises a sports day for the employees every couple of months and everyone is encouraged to play. The company has some serious sportsmen as well. One employee is trying for IPL while another has played cricket for West Bengal.

While Nangia feels that golf is too slow for him at present, he hopes to pick it up in the future. But a sport that has taken his fancy currently is football. "I played it a few times and I would definitely like to play it more," he says. Nangia's love for sports is not restricted to just playing but also watching it on television. "I can watch the highlights of the 1996 [Cricket] World Cup again and again," says Nangia adding that

"Sports teaches you about your mistakes, your failures, how to get back on track, being a team player. I have not found a single sportsperson who is not a great team player"

he loves cricket and at most times some sport or the other is playing on the television in the background even when he is working.

Smytten was set up in 2016 to help brands reach out to customers at a significantly lower cost than traditional methods. "We are sitting on a lot of rich data on the pre-purchase side of it. So if a brand today wants to know what a person could potentially buy, I can tell them," says Nangia who previously worked with Unilever. Nangia wants to get into the offline space and also go international. Smytten has received five rounds of funding till now. **BT**

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PHOTO BY SUDHIR DAMERLA

PLAY ON Mathew Joseph has composed electronic dance music (EDM) tracks

MUSICAL NOTES

Mathew Joseph, CEO and Co-founder of Sleepyhead, enjoys playing the keyboard and composing his own music

BY SMITA TRIPATHI

For 38-year-old Mathew Joseph, CEO and Co-founder of Sleepyhead—an online-only home lifestyle brand, music has been a part of his life since childhood. "I started playing the piano when I was five and later moved to the keyboard," says Joseph, who was introduced to everything from western classical to Indian classical and heavy metal by his parents who loved music.

So which is his favourite genre? "It doesn't exist. It depends totally on my mood." Joseph goes from playing soft western classical such as compositions by Beethoven to heavy metal such as music by Ozzy Osbourne depending upon how he is feeling. "The keyboard is quite versatile to bring any form of music to life," he says.

While he was trained to play the piano as a child in boarding school in Ooty, he now plays music by the ear and composes his own music as well. "Over the years, how we compose music has evolved. About two decades ago there weren't many kinds of software that helped you compose music. Today there are several such software to edit tracks and compose music. So now it's no longer just about playing music

but also understanding the software," says Joseph who has composed electronic dance music (EDM) tracks. Joseph played with two different bands when he was at Christ College in Bengaluru. "I focussed on multiple genres and even played Indian fusion music." Joseph is now trying to introduce his young daughter to music, just like his parents introduced him.

Sleepyhead is a subsidiary of Duroflex. It is a five-year-old brand and crossed ₹200 crore in revenue this year. Joseph says that when you are an e-commerce-only brand, you have to be careful that products are logistics-friendly. Sleepyhead started with mattresses and then ventured into furnishings and furniture. "It is a value-for-money brand. Since we don't have an offline presence, we save on various costs that are passed on to our customers," says Joseph. Sleepyhead is a younger, more vibrant brand than Duroflex and targets a different set of customers. Joseph says Bengaluru is currently its biggest market since the city has a young IT crowd which is setting up homes. **BT**

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